



ReGen Civics Quest Field Guide

Community Gathering

regencivics.earth

What This Quest Is

Gather 10+ humans in a held circle to witness each other honestly — without advice, without fixing, without performing. An ancient technology for genuine presence and collective healing. Share whatever healing modality you are most aligned with.

Story Card

Most of what passes for support in our culture is advice. Someone shares something painful and the person listening immediately starts solving it. The result is that the person sharing feels even more alone, because what they needed was not a solution. They needed to be witnessed. A healing circle is a different technology. Structured. Held. Ancient. When everyone can see everyone else, hierarchy dissolves. The quality of attention is different. The depth of what people are willing to say is different. And what happens after, in how the people relate to each other, is different.

How To Do This Quest

Step 1: Study the basics of circle-holding.

Read at least one resource on facilitation or circle practice. Understand the difference between advising and witnessing, between fixing and holding.

Step 2: Design your circle.

Who will you gather? What is the container? What is the opening, the talking-object structure, the closing?

Step 3: Set agreements with the group before you start.

Minimum agreements: confidentiality, no advice unless asked, speak from your own experience, listen to understand. Read these aloud at the opening.

Step 4: Hold the circle.

Let each person speak without interruption. Pause after each share. Invite the group to be with what was shared before moving on. Do not fill the silence.

Step 5: Close with intention.

End with a brief closing round: one word or sentence from each person about what they are leaving with.

Step 6: Reflect and share.

After the circle, write or record a reflection on how it went. What worked? What did you learn about holding space?

Deliverable

Documentation of a healing circle you held: the structure you used, what happened, and your reflection as the holder.

Tips

- Your first circle will not be perfect. Hold it anyway.
- The most common mistake: talking too much as the facilitator.
- Circles work best with 4-12 people. Larger than 12 becomes hard to hold.
- Outdoor circles around fire are particularly powerful.

Resources

- The Way of Council by Jack Zimmerman and Virginia Coyle
- Nonviolent Communication by Marshall Rosenberg
- Joanna Macy's Work That Reconnects

A Place to Write

Notes from your circle design and reflection:
